

Course on Knowledge Graphs in the era of Large Language Models

Session 3: Reasoning with RDFS Semantics and OWL 2 RL

Ernesto Jiménez-Ruiz

February 19, 2026

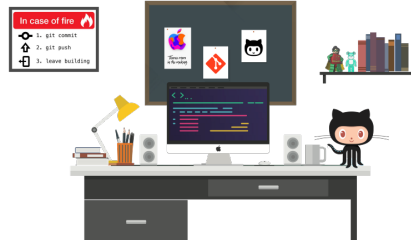
Contents

1	Git Repositories and dependencies	2
2	Inference rules (cheatsheet)	2
3	RDFS inference	3
3.1	Manual inference	3
3.1.1	Example solution	4
3.2	RDFS inference programmatically	4
4	OWL 2 RL entailment	4
4.1	Manual entailment	5
4.2	OWL2 RL entailment programmatically	5
5	Solutions	6
5.1	Task 3.1	6
5.2	Task 3.2	7
5.3	Task 3.3	7
5.4	Task 3.4	7

1 Git Repositories and dependencies

Support codes for the laboratory sessions are available in *GitHub*. There are two repositories, one in Python and another in Java:

<https://github.com/city-knowledge-graphs>



For Java developers we use maven to deal with dependencies (see pom file). For Python developers there is always a `requirements.txt` within each lab folder with possibly new dependencies. It is recommended to use environments, but it is not strictly necessary.

2 Inference rules (cheatsheet)

As seen in the lecture, Figure 1 summarizes the necessary inference rules we need for the lab.

Rule	If	Then add	
rdf1	$(x \text{ p } y)$	$(p \text{ rdf:type rdf:Property})$	
rdfs2	$(p \text{ rdfs:domain } c) \ (x \text{ p } y)$	$(x \text{ rdf:type } c)$	
rdfs3	$(p \text{ rdfs:range } c) \ (x \text{ p } y)$	$(y \text{ rdf:type } c)$	
rdfs4a	$(x \text{ p } y)$	$(x \text{ rdf:type rdfs:Resource})$	
rdfs4b	$(x \text{ p } y)$	$(y \text{ rdf:type rdfs:Resource})$	
rdfs5	$(p \text{ rdfs:subPropertyOf } q) \ (q \text{ rdfs:subPropertyOf } r)$	$(p \text{ rdfs:subPropertyOf } r)$	schema only
rdfs6	$(p \text{ rdf:type rdf:Property})$	$(P \text{ rdfs:subPropertyOf } p)$	
rdfs7	$(p \text{ rdfs:subPropertyOf } q) \ (x \text{ p } y)$	$(x \text{ q } y)$	data + schema
rdfs8	$(c \text{ rdf:type rdfs:Class})$	$(c \text{ rdfs:subClassOf rdfs:Resource})$	
rdfs9	$(c \text{ rdfs:subClassOf } d) \ (x \text{ rdf:type } c)$	$(x \text{ rdf:type } d)$	not relevant
rdfs10	$(c \text{ rdf:type rdfs:Class})$	$(c \text{ rdfs:subClassOf } c)$	
rdfs11	$(c \text{ rdfs:subClassOf } d) \ (d \text{ rdfs:subClassOf } e)$	$(c \text{ rdfs:subClassOf } e)$	
rdfs12	$(p \text{ rdf:type rdfs:ContainerMembershipProperty})$	$(p \text{ rdfs:subPropertyOf rdfs:Member})$	
rdfs13	$(x \text{ rdf:type rdfs:Datatype})$	$(x \text{ rdfs:subClassOf rdfs:Literal})$	
	$(p \text{ owl:inverseOf } q)$	$(q \text{ owl:inverseOf } p)$	
	$(p \text{ owl:inverseOf } q) \ (x \text{ p } y)$	$(y \text{ q } x)$	
	$(p \text{ rdf:type owl:SymmetricProperty}) \ (x \text{ p } y)$	$(y \text{ p } x)$	

Figure 1: Figure adapted from “Towards Efficient Schema-Enhanced Pattern Matching over RDF Data Streams”. International Semantic Web Conference (ISWC) 2011. Slides.

3 RDFS inference

Consider the following set of triples (we will refer to them as the graph $\mathcal{G}_{\text{rdfs}}$).

```
1 @PREFIX : <http://city.ac.uk/kg/lab4/>
2 @PREFIX rdf: <http://www.w3.org/1999/02/22-rdf-syntax-ns#>
3 @PREFIX rdfs: <http://www.w3.org/2000/01/rdf-schema#> .
4 :Person a rdfs:Class .
5 :Man a rdfs:Class ;
6 rdfs:subClassOf :Person .
7 :Woman a rdfs:Class ;
8 rdfs:subClassOf :Person .
9 :Parent a rdfs:Class ;
10 rdfs:subClassOf :Person .
11 :Father a rdfs:Class ;
12 rdfs:subClassOf :Parent ;
13 rdfs:subClassOf :Man .
14 :Mother a rdfs:Class;
15 rdfs:subClassOf :Parent ;
16 rdfs:subClassOf :Woman .
17 :Child a rdfs:Class ;
18 rdfs:subClassOf :Person .
19 :hasParent a rdf:Property ;
20 rdfs:domain :Person ;
21 rdfs:range :Parent .
22 :hasFather a rdf:Property ;
23 rdfs:subPropertyOf :hasParent ;
24 rdfs:range :Father .
25 :hasMother a rdf:Property ;
26 rdfs:subPropertyOf :hasParent ;
27 rdfs:range :Mother .
28 :isChildOf a rdf:Property ;
29 rdfs:domain :Child ;
30 rdfs:range :Parent .
31 :Ann a :Person ;
32 :hasFather :Carl ;
33 :hasMother :Juliet .
```

3.1 Manual inference

Task 3.1 Decide if $\mathcal{G}_{\text{rdfs}}$ derives the following statement(s) and explain *why* or *why not*. In the positive case, then indicate the RDFS inference rules from the lecture (also found at <http://www.w3.org/TR/rdf-mt/>) to prove your answer. If the statement is not derived, then explain, informally or formally, why this is so. Formally can be done via a counterexample, *i.e.*, with an interpretation that entails $\mathcal{G}_{\text{rdfs}}$, but it does not the statement.

Statement 1 :Father rdfs:subClassOf :Person .

Statement 2 :Woman rdfs:subClassOf :Person .

Statement 3 :Juliet a :Person .

Statement 4 `:Ann a :Child .`

Statement 5 `:Ann :isChildOf :Carl .`

Statement 6 `:Ann :hasParent :Juliet .`

Statement 7 `rdfs:range rdf:type rdfs:Resource .`

Statement 8 `:Mother rdfs:subClassOf :Person .`

3.1.1 Example solution

Example solution for Statement 1:

```
:Father rdfs:subClassOf :Person .
```

True, the statements is derived by $\mathcal{G}_{\text{rdfs}}$. `:Father` is (transitively) a subclass of `:Person`. Rule **rdfs11**. Statements 1 and 2 below are found in $\mathcal{G}_{\text{rdfs}}$ and are premises to the application of the inference rule **rdfs11**, which yields the statement we're after (Statement 3).

Proof:

1. `:Father rdfs:subClassOf :Parent` — P
2. `:Parent rdfs:subClassOf :Person` — P
3. `:Father rdfs:subClassOf :Person` — 1, 2, rdfs11

In the proof above each line is marked with "P" if the statement is a premise, *i.e.*, exists in $\mathcal{G}$, or with the rdfs rule and the line identification of the input statements.

3.2 RDFS inference programmatically

We are using the OWL-RL python library which builds on top of RDFLib and has an RDFS reasoning component.¹ The file in GitHub `RDFSReasoning.py` expands our example graph $\mathcal{G}$ using the RDFS inference rules. A Jupyter notebook is also provided.

Task 3.2: Check if the statements in **Task 3.1** are True or False over the extended graph or model (*i.e.*, the graph after applying reasoning). The graph $\mathcal{G}_{\text{rdfs}}$ is provided within the file `lab-rdfs.ttl`.

4 OWL 2 RL entailment

Consider the following set of triples (we will refer to them as the graph $\mathcal{G}_{\text{owl2rl}}$).

¹Documentation: <https://github.com/RDFLib/OWL-RL>

```

1 @PREFIX : <http://city.ac.uk/kg/lab4/>
2 @PREFIX rdf: <http://www.w3.org/1999/02/22-rdf-syntax-ns#>
3 @PREFIX rdfs: <http://www.w3.org/2000/01/rdf-schema#> .
4 @PREFIX owl: <http://www.w3.org/2002/07/owl#> .
5 :Person a owl:Class .
6 :Man a owl:Class ;
7     rdfs:subClassOf :Person .
8 :Woman a owl:Class ;
9     rdfs:subClassOf :Person .
10 :Parent a owl:Class ;
11     rdfs:subClassOf :Person .
12 :Father a owl:Class ;
13     rdfs:subClassOf :Parent ;
14     rdfs:subClassOf :Man .
15 :Mother a owl:Class ;
16     rdfs:subClassOf :Parent ;
17     rdfs:subClassOf :Woman .
18 :hasChild a owl:ObjectProperty ;
19     owl:inverseOf :hasParent .
20 :hasParent a owl:ObjectProperty ;
21     rdfs:domain :Person ;
22     rdfs:range :Parent .
23 :hasFather a owl:ObjectProperty ;
24     rdfs:subPropertyOf :hasParent ;
25     rdfs:range :Father .
26 :hasMother a owl:ObjectProperty ;
27     rdfs:subPropertyOf :hasParent ;
28     rdfs:range :Mother .
29 :Ann a :Person ;
30     :hasFather :Carl ;
31     :hasMother :Juliet .

```

4.1 Manual entailment

Task 3.3. Indicate if the following statements are derived by $\mathcal{G}_{\text{owl2rl}}$. $\mathcal{G}_{\text{owl2rl}}$ is within the OWL 2 RL profile so one could apply, among many others, similar inference rules to those for RDFS.² Indicate in your proof which are the involved triples from $\mathcal{G}_{\text{owl2rl}}$.

Statement 1 :Juliet :hasChild :Ann .

Statement 2 :Ann a :Child .

4.2 OWL2 RL entailment programmatically

We are using the OWL-RL python library. The file `OWLReasoning.py` in GitHub expands our example graph $\mathcal{G}_{\text{owl2rl}}$ using OWL 2 RL reasoning. A Jupyter notebook is also provided.

²https://www.w3.org/TR/owl2-profiles/#Reasoning_in_OWL_2_RL_and_RDF_Graphs_using_Rules

Task 3.4. Check programmatically if the above statements (Task 3.3) are True or False over the extended graph (*i.e.*, after applying reasoning). The graph $\mathcal{G}_{\text{owl2rl}}$ is provided within the file `lab-owl2rl.ttl` in the corresponding `lab4` folders.

5 Solutions

5.1 Task 3.1

Statement 2

```
:Woman rdfs:subClassOf :Person .
```

True. This triple is explicitly stated in $\mathcal{G}$.

Statement 3

```
:Juliet a :Person .
```

True. Proof:

1. `:Ann :hasMother :Juliet .` — P
2. `:hasMother rdfs:range :Mother .` — P
3. `:Juliet rdf:type :Mother` — 1, 2, rdfs3
4. `:Mother rdfs:subClassOf :Woman` — P
5. `:Woman rdfs:subClassOf :Person` — P
6. `:Mother rdfs:subClassOf :Person` — 4, 5, rdfs11
7. `:Juliet rdf:type :Person` — 3, 6, rdfs9

Statement 4

```
:Ann a :Child .
```

False. It seems intuitive that `:Ann` is a child, but there is not connection between `:Ann` and `:Child` that can be entailed. To get this inference, `:hasFather` and/or `:hasMother` should be declared as sub-property of `:isChildOf`.

Statement 5

```
:Ann :isChildOf :Carl .
```

False. Similarly to Statement 4.

Statement 6

```
:Ann :hasParent :Juliet .
```

True. Proof:

1. `:Ann :hasMother :Juliet — P`
2. `:hasMother rdfs:subPropertyOf :hasParent — P`
3. `:Ann :hasParent :Juliet — 1, 2, rdfs7`

Statement 7

`rdfs:range rdf:type rdfs:Resource .`

True. This statement is an axiomatic triple and is always satisfied in RDFS models.

Statement 8

`:Mother rdfs:subClassOf :Person .`

True. Similarly to Statement 1.

5.2 Task 3.2

Solutions in GitHub. The solutions use ASK queries (we will learn about them in our Session 5) over the extended graph. Check the solution files in the GitHub repository.

5.3 Task 3.3

Statement 1

`:Juliet :hasChild :Ann .`

True. Proof:

1. `:Ann :hasMother :Juliet — P`
2. `:hasMother rdfs:subPropertyOf :hasParent — P`
3. `:hasChild owl:inverseOf :hasParent — P`
4. `:Ann :hasParent :Juliet — 1, 2, rdfs73`
5. `:Juliet :hasChild :Ann — 3, 4, prp-inv24`

Statement 2

`:Ann a :Child .`

False. Ann is the child/daughter of Carl and Juliet but there is not a class `:Child`. For this statement to hold, the range of `:hasChild` should be `:Child`.

5.4 Task 3.4

Solutions in GitHub. As for the RDFS case, the solutions use ASK queries over the extended graph. Check the solution files in the GitHub repository.

³Or *prp-spo1* with respect to OWL 2 RL reasoning.

⁴OWL 2 RL reasoning: https://www.w3.org/TR/owl2-profiles/#Reasoning_in_OWL_2_RL_and_RDF_Graphs_using_Rules